

Louis Kotze CV

Louis Kotze

Senior Full-Stack Engineer · Linux Kernel Contributor

Stilbay, Western Cape (Remote · GMT+2 / SAST) · louis@louiskotze.dev · +27 82 056 7675 · linkedin.com/in/louis-kotze · github.com/louis-kotze

SUMMARY

Senior engineer with 10+ years across full-stack product delivery, platform architecture, and systems-level open-source. Ships production code for enterprise clients in pharmaceuticals, automotive, and FinTech, and contributes upstream to the Linux kernel and wireless-regdb. Leads small distributed teams across time zones.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Developer, iOCO Digital (contract to Takeda) · May 2025 – Present

Lead a team of 3 engineers delivering a data-visualization platform used across Takeda's internal analytics teams. Part of a 14-team product group; directly coordinate with 4 of those teams plus chapter leads in India, business stakeholders in Switzerland, and a product owner in the US.

- Shipped 5 new chart types on the platform (geographic, work-management, and process-insight views), widening its coverage across supply-chain, site operations, and work-management data for Takeda's internal users
- Designing a multi-view layer that lets analysts pivot between renderings of the same dataset without leaving the page
- Driving AI-assisted development adoption within the team: KT sessions, restructuring the codebase for agent-friendly context (Copilot / Claude Code / Codex), and automated Copilot-driven PR reviews
- Stack: Angular 21, Highcharts, GraphQL, Storybook, GitHub Actions

Senior Software Developer, BMW IT Hub South Africa · Aug 2021 – May 2025

Led engineering on the Group Document Management System and Technical Action Database for BMW, working across teams in Germany, South Africa, and Portugal (team size 3–7).

- Engineered BMW's Group Document Management System for international legal-document retention: per-country classification drove statutory retention windows, version history preserved historical drafts as required by law, end-of-life prompts flagged documents nearing expiry, and daily compliance jobs purged documents past their statutory due date
- Led Kafka rollout linking BMW's warranty-case management systems into a unified real-time event pipeline, replacing siloed stage-by-stage processing across the warranty admin lifecycle
- Technical Maintenance Manager for the resulting high-volume transactional system: production support, deployments, CI/CD, and database administration
- Mentored 3 Harambee Youth Employment Accelerator graduates through their 6-month rotation on the team

Software Developer, Discovery Limited · Jun 2019 – Jul 2021

- Designed reusable CRM components adopted across Discovery's product lines, reducing duplication for downstream teams
- Prototyped candidate architectures and presented in the Software Architect forum to shape company-wide technical standards

Software Developer, Hello Group · Jan 2016 – May 2019

- Championed Kubernetes and WSO2 adoption, establishing the standard microservices infrastructure across the company
- Delivered FinTech compliance systems audited by SARB and Deloitte UK
- Built remittance interfaces expanding the business into Malawi, Zimbabwe, and Bangladesh
- System lead for a critical project during a month-long deployment in India

OPEN-SOURCE & UPSTREAM CONTRIBUTIONS

- **Linux kernel (linux-wireless):** Authored RTL8922AU USB RF-calibration timeout fix, merged into Ping-Ke Shih's `rtw-next` tree (Apr 2026) with 5 independent Tested-by tags across USB chipsets. Also a `cfg80211` MLO group-key error-message grammar fix (Accepted by Johannes Berg).
- **wireless-regdb:** Authored 5 country patches (ZA, HK, RU, KR, UA) verified against primary regulatory sources (ICASA, OFCA, MSIT, SCRF, ETSI), all merged into `wens/wireless-regdb` (Apr 2026). Also provided peer-review (Reviewed-by) on a community-submitted RU 6 GHz 320 MHz patch, applied to `wens/wireless-regdb` master 2026-04-30: 6 total commits across 5 jurisdictions in one month, including first review credit on someone else's regulatory analysis.
- **morrownr/rtw89:** PR #76 backporting the in-kernel RF-calibration fix to the out-of-tree DKMS driver (merged Apr 2026).
- Filed Fedora bug 2458629 with reproducer and root-cause analysis for a `wpa_supplicant` MLO reassociation race; assigned, in triage.

SKILLS

Primary stack: Angular, TypeScript, JavaScript, GraphQL, Highcharts, Storybook

Backend & platform: Java, Kafka, Kubernetes, Docker, microservices, REST/GraphQL API design

Cloud & infra: Azure, AWS, GCP, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Prometheus, Grafana

Systems / low-level: Linux kernel modules, wireless stack, C (kernel-adjacent), bash

Practice: Distributed team leadership, mentoring, Agile/Scrum, code review, technical writing (kernel-grade commit messages)

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Diploma in IT: Software Development:** Varsity College, 2013–2015 (Top Student, all 3 years)
- Professional Scrum Master (PSM 1), Professional Scrum Developer (PSD 1)
- ICF Coaching Skills for Managers (30 hours)